

Χορίκιος ὁ Γαζαῖος

Choricius of Gaza and the Encomium of Bishop Marcian

eul_aid: uvo

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή Χριστιανική [Christian Koine](#)
Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)
Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)

Choricius of Gaza was a Greek sophist and rhetorician active in the early sixth century CE. A native of Gaza, he was a student of Procopius of Gaza and succeeded him as the city's leading public orator. His career flourished under the patronage of Bishop Marcian and the provincial governor Aratius, for whom he delivered several speeches, during the reigns of emperors Anastasius I and Justin I. His work reflects the synthesis of classical education and Christianity characteristic of Gaza's late antique cultural milieu.

His corpus consists of orations and declamations. These include short introductory speeches, marriage speeches, and funeral orations for his teacher Procopius and Bishop Marcian. He also composed panegyrics and declamations on mythological themes. Particularly notable are two detailed descriptions: one of the paintings in the bath of Aratius, and another of the church of St. Stephen in Gaza.

Choricius represents the final phase of the Second Sophistic in the Christian East. His works provide valuable insight into the social and intellectual life of a sixth-century provincial city, demonstrating the adaptation of classical rhetoric for Christian contexts. His descriptive works are important literary records of now-lost art and architecture.

Works (1)

- Ἐγκώμιον εἰς Μαρκιανὸν Ἐπίσκοπον · [Encomium for Bishop Marcian](#) · 1413 passages